

scripts/systemd-status.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-08-12 (initial version) **Inheritance:** HelixConstitution §11.4.18 + Lava §6.B (Container "Up" is not application-healthy)

Overview

Convenience wrapper that reports the lava-api-go systemd --user unit's state **and** the underlying container's real health, in one command. This exists specifically because of §6.B: a systemd unit can report active (via RemainAfterExit=yes) while the container inside it has crash-looped — the unit's own status alone is a necessary, never sufficient, signal.

Usage

```
./scripts/systemd-status.sh
```

Output sections

1. systemctl --user status lava-api.service — unit-level state (active/inactive, linger dependency).
2. loginctl show-user <you> --property=Linger — confirms the unit can start at boot without a login session.
3. tools/lava-containers/bin/lava-containers -cmd=status — **the load-bearing signal:** real runtime (podman/docker), Healthy: true/false, LAN IP, and the live /health URL. This is the same status command documented in the root CLAUDE.md under "Run the proxy locally".

A healthy deployment shows the unit active AND Healthy: true. Either one alone is not sufficient evidence the API actually works — see the root CLAUDE.md §6.B forensic anchor (the healthprobe binary that silently failed while the container reported Up).